



China Steel - Channel checker

10-day China steel production -1% vs previous (+1% YoY). FOB iron ore prices flat since start of conflict as shipping costs rise

10-day China steel output 1,026Mt annualised, -1% vs previous: latest China daily crude steel output (10 days to 20 May) is tracking at a run rate of 1,026Mt annualised, -1% vs previous 10-day period (to 10 May), +1% YoY. Trailing 30-day steel production is +3% vs the previous 30 days and flat YoY, tracking at the bottom end of the 5-year range.

Spot CFR iron ore prices have eased back to \$105/t, but freight rates have increased to a post-Iran high of \$15.65/t Australia-China, Brazil-China is \$36.25/t. Net of freight, Australian FOB prices are \$2/t higher vs before the conflict (+3%), Brazil FOB prices are \$5/t lower (-7%). Our latest JPM Global iron ore market analysis raised prices ~\$5/t ([link](#)) to \$105/\$99/t in 2026/27 and JPM raised our long-term real price to \$90/t (\$80/t previous). These CFR price increases reflect higher marginal costs in the industry cost curve, rather than a demand driven increase.

Following a major accident at the Liushenyu coal mine in Shanxi, China, JPM APAC Mining estimates ~122Mt, or ~3% of China's total coking coal capacity is suspended ([link](#)). Shanxi represents ~30% of China's coking coal capacity and a prolonged shut down could meaningfully impact prices. China coking coal futures prices increased >10% since the accident. Separately, Mysteel reports production inspections in China's key energy intensive sectors, which could lead to restrictions in aluminium ([link](#)).

We published our EMEA Metals & Mining sector update today ([link](#)) and note that EMEA Miners trade at <10% vs Fair Value under our base case, taking into account 5-10% cost inflation and a cautious outlook for global macroeconomic environment. With rich valuations and global macro uncertainties, we remain UW Anglo American & Kumba Iron Ore, Neutral on BHP, Rio Tinto & Glencore. Norsk Hydro continues to be our only OW in the Industrials Metals space for its exposure to aluminium.

European Metals, Mining & Steel

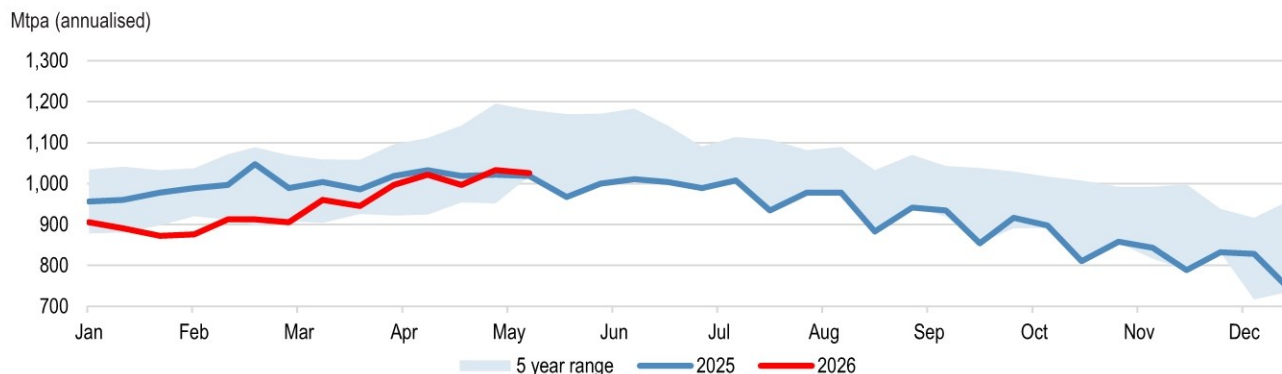
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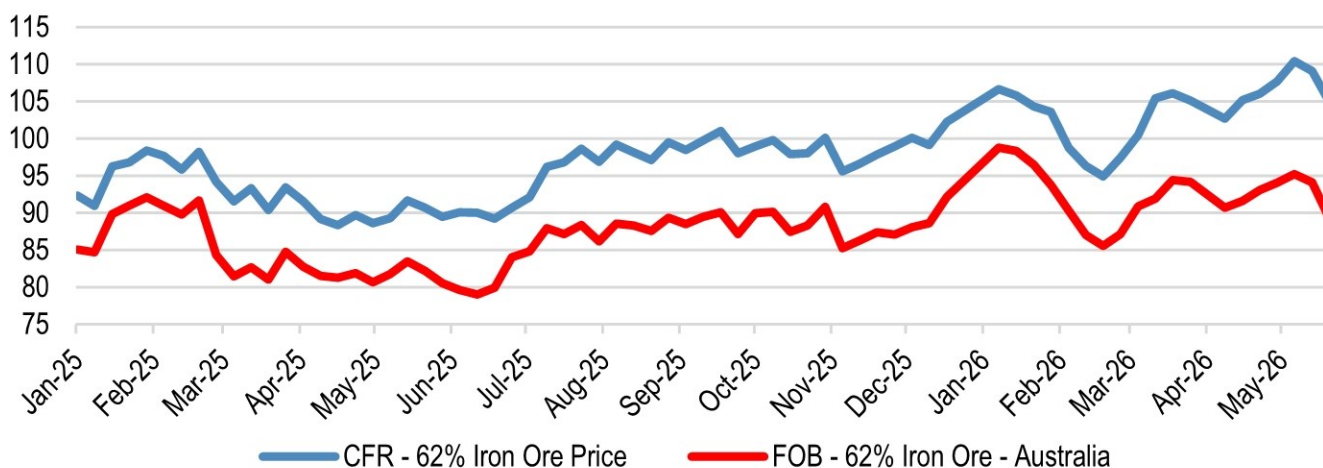
Figure 1: Total China steel output 1,026Mt annualised run rate: daily CISA steel output for 10-days ended 20 May: -1% vs previous (+1% YoY), in line with seasonal trend



Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, CISA, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 2: FOB iron ore price from Australia to China at ~\$89/t, flat vs end of Feb

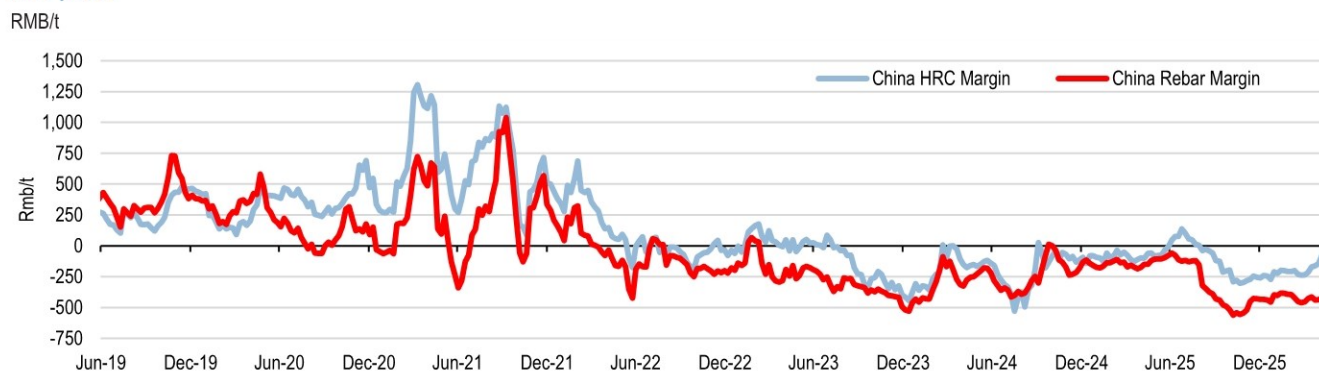
LHS: Iron ore price \$/mt; RHS: Shipping cost \$/mt



FOB 62% Iron Ore price calculated as CFR 62% Iron Ore price less West Australia to Qingdao bulk shipping costs.

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

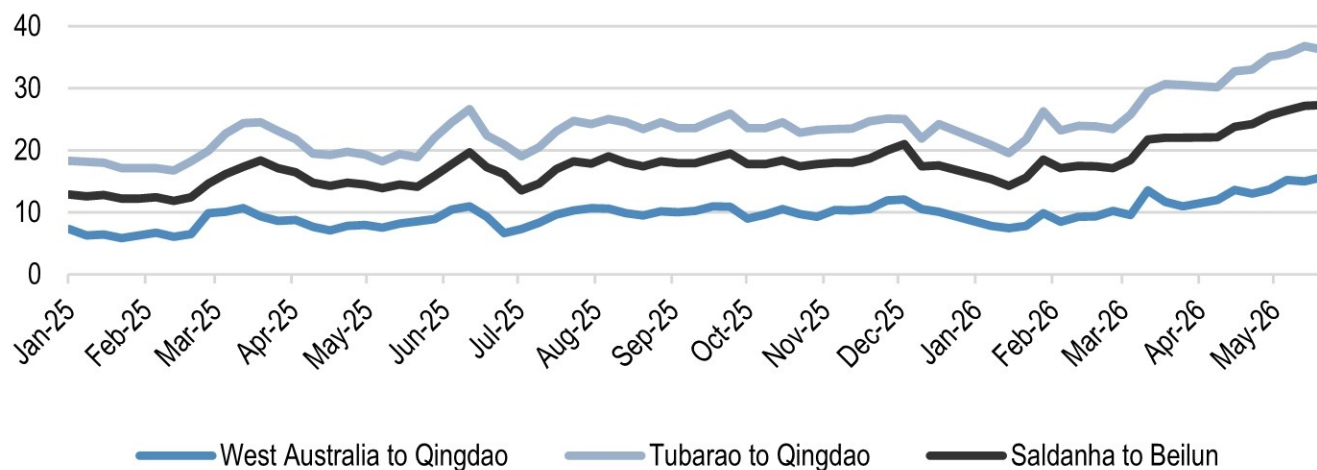
Figure 3: China steel mill margins remain loss making but China HRC margins have shown improvements in the past few weeks on improving onshore HRC prices



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 4: Iron ore bulk shipping costs from Australia, Brazil and South Africa to China are all +>45% since start of the Iran conflict

LHS: Iron ore price \$/mt; RHS: Shipping cost \$/mt

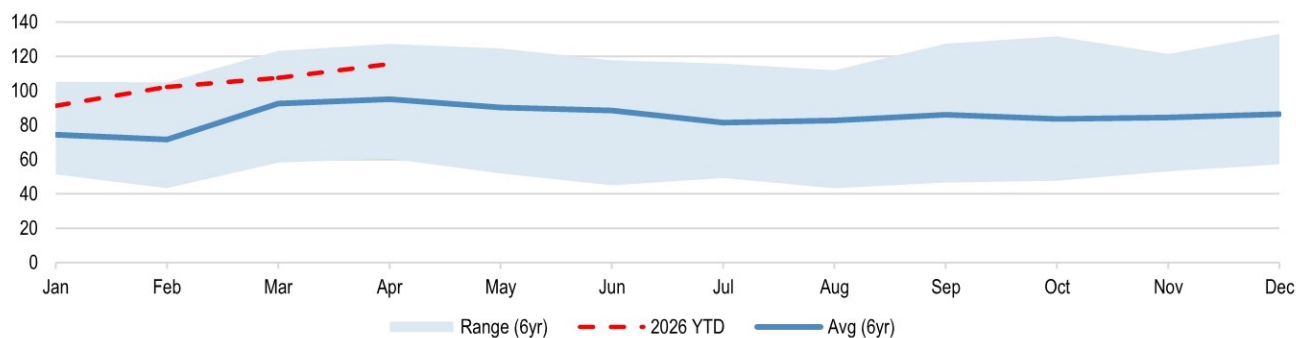


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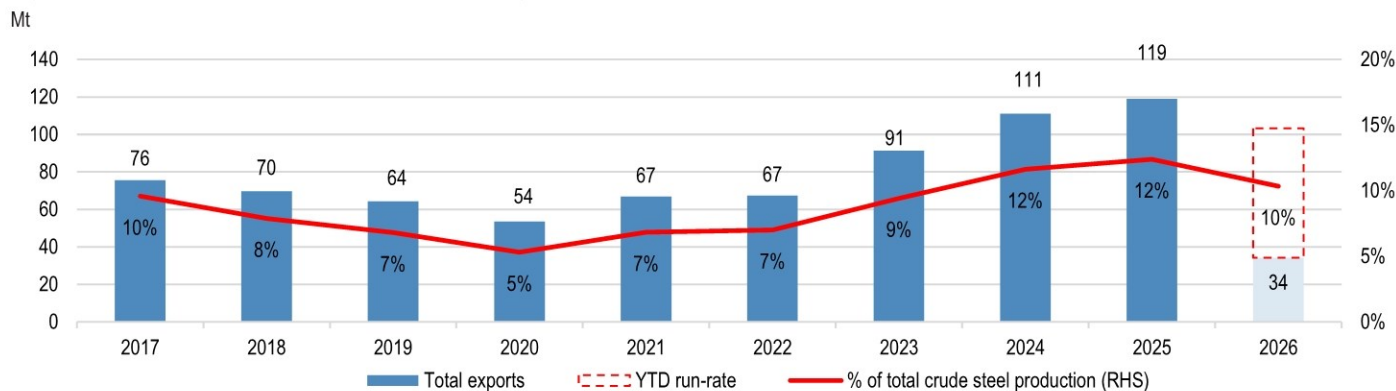
Figure 5: Total China Steel exports (seasonality): Apr'26 export run-rate of 116Mtpa at top end of historical average

Mtpa exports (annualised)



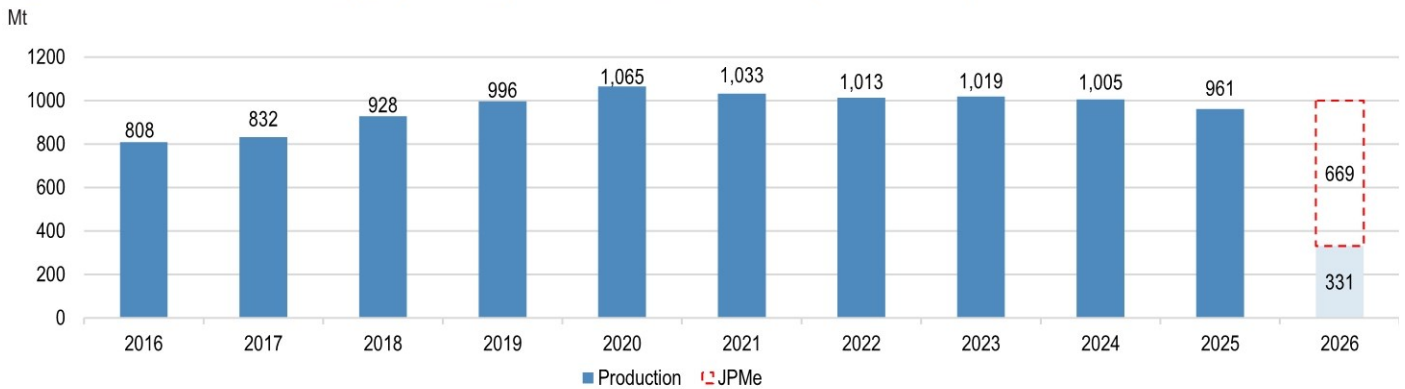
Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 6: 4M'2026 China steel exports at 34Mt, tracking at ~ 10% of total output



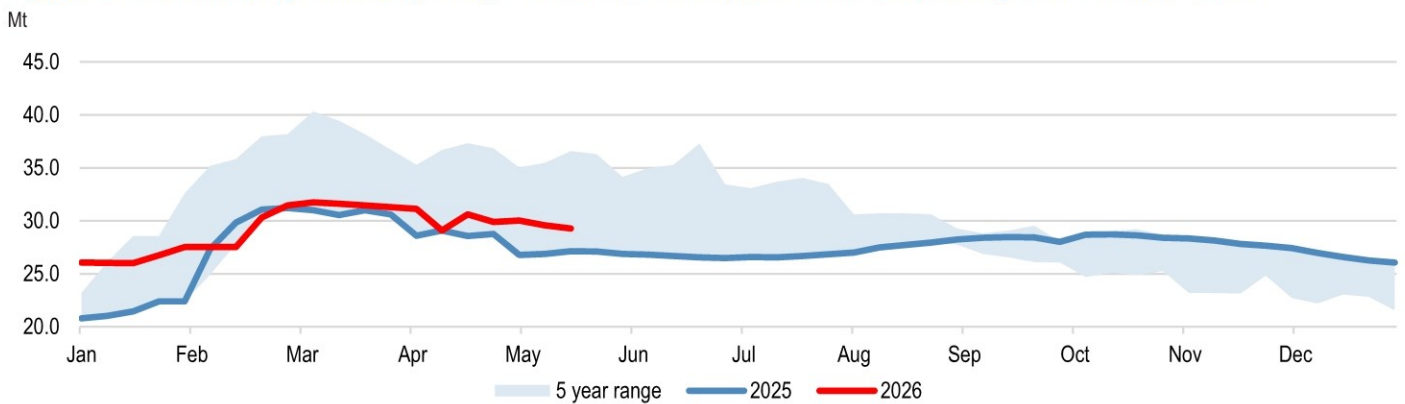
Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 7: Official NBS China steel output (annualised) – we estimate 2026 China steel production at ~1,000Mt



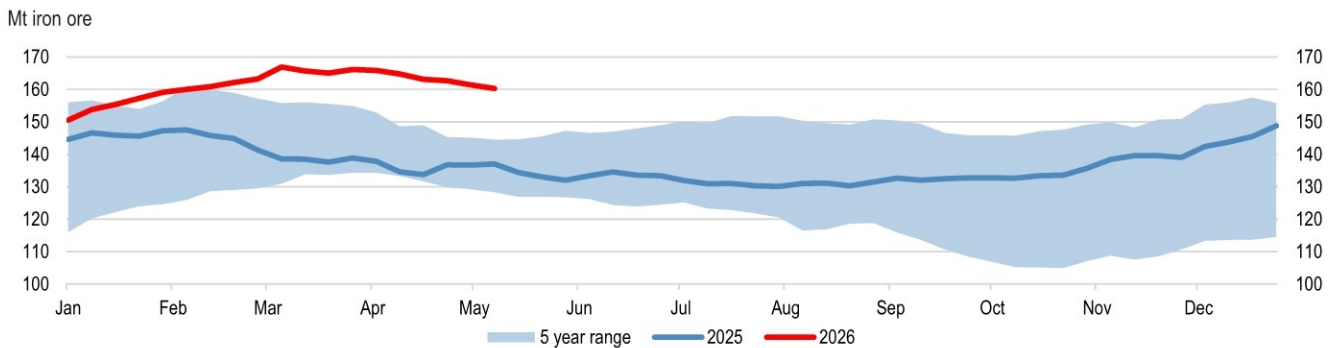
Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, NBS, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 8: China steel inventory week ending 21 May, -1% WoW and +9% YoY; total steel inventory tracking in line with seasonal level



Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 9: Iron Ore inventory held at ports in China at ~160Mt, tracking at historical high but 7Mt down since peak inventory in March



Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

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